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RETAIN

Learning under Crisis: How Countries of Eastern Europe, Caucasus and Central Asia Build Educational System Resilience

The CEDOS study analyzes how Global Partnership for Education partner countries overcome systemic educational gaps caused by armed conflicts, natural disasters and public health crises. The key finding: crises do not merely disrupt education -- they deepen pre-existing structural problems including unequal access, poor teacher preparation and lack of adaptive curricula. A

resilient education system is framed not as restoration to a pre-crisis state, but as the capacity to transform and produce relevant competencies under new conditions.

3R: RETAIN signal: structural condition for human capital accumulation. The education system is the primary competency pipeline -- without its resilience, any reskilling effort remains point-based and unscalable. For Ukraine, where education has been disrupted by war, this is a direct risk indicator of systemic brain waste reproduction: a younger generation may acquire formal credentials without the real competencies demanded by the market. The regional comparative analysis provides operational lessons for education reform as a component of the RETAIN strategy.

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